

Eli R. Hooten, Ph.D.

CTO / Developer / Engineer

elir.hooten@gmail.com | elihooten.com | linkedin.com/in/hootener | github.com/hootener

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

I'm a technical co-founder with a Ph.D. in Computer Science from Vanderbilt University and over a decade of experience building and scaling software companies. As CTO of GameWisp I grew the team from zero to ten, led the technical design of products that drove \$4M in ARR, and helped lead the company to an acquisition by Lightstream in 2018.

In 2018 I co-founded Codecov, where as CTO I scaled the team and many supporting functions including engineering, product, design, and support. I helped turn Codecov into an industry-leading developer tool used by over a million software developers worldwide. Codecov was acquired by Sentry in 2022, where I continued as Director of Engineering — leading Codecov's transition from a single-purpose coverage tool to a broader code quality platform.

In 2025, I began work on Line, an AI powered deal and workflow tool for the group hospitality segment. As CTO and Co-Founder, I build the product, guide technical decision making, and assist with fundraising and overall business strategy.

EXPERIENCE

CTO / Co-Founder

2025 – Present

Line

- Build the product and guide technical decision making.
- Assist with fundraising and overall business strategy.

Director of Engineering, Codecov

2022 – 2025

Sentry; Remote

Post-acquisition of Codecov by Sentry, I continued to serve as the technical and product leader for Codecov.

- Devised and led Codecov's transition from a single-purpose code coverage tool to a robust code quality platform.
- Scaled the Engineering, Design, and Product functions across multiple product areas, hiring both individual contributors and managers.
- Successfully transitioned a team of 30 to the principles, culture, and working practices of Sentry with minimal attrition.
- Led coordination efforts between Sentry and Codecov teams to launch key product integrations and new features.
- Moved Codecov from closed source to a fully open source company by making all source code and product planning publicly available.

Co-Founder / CTO

2018 – 2022

Codecov; Remote

I oversaw all technical operations at Codecov, including engineering, technical support, solutions engineering, and product.

- Executed multiple product and engineering initiatives that grew Codecov's annual recurring revenue multiple times over.
- Helped scale our team from 3 to 30+ globally distributed employees and contractors.
- Directly led the engineering, product, design, solutions engineering, and technical support teams.
- Served as the technical point of contact for stakeholders from many of the world's largest companies.
- Continually set the product roadmap and long-term technical direction.

CTO / Co-Founder

2012 – 2018

GameWisp, Inc.; Nashville, TN

I was directly responsible for GameWisp's technology and product strategy; overseeing the design and development of core software products for gaming livestreamers and content creators. GameWisp's core technology was acquired by Lightstream in 2019.

- Grew a diverse team from 1 to 10 employees and contractors.
- Shipped products that resulted in over \$4M in Annual Recurring Revenue.
- Designed and developed performant and cost-effective video upload, encoding, and delivery systems utilized by thousands of active users.
- Developed production quality REST and WebSocket APIs used by hundreds of third-party developers.
- Routinely developed user-facing features and shipped production-ready code.
- Sat GameWisp's board and assisted with the overall strategic direction of the company.

Research Assistant

2009 – 2014

Department of Electrical Engineering and Computer Science; Vanderbilt University; Nashville, TN

I received my Ph.D. in 2014 from Vanderbilt University, studying human-computer interaction and human-robot interaction under Professor Julie A. Adams.

- Developed design prototypes for academic research using C++/Qt, Ruby on Rails, and JavaScript.
- Performed statistical analysis on real-world user interaction data using R.
- Independently designed, sourced, assembled, and flight tested unmanned aerial vehicles and balloons for archaeological field use in South America.
- Supported archaeological survey teams in remote areas of Peru by providing on-site hardware and software development.

EDUCATION

Ph.D., Computer Science

2014

Vanderbilt University, Nashville, TN

M.Sc., Computer Science

2013

Vanderbilt University, Nashville, TN

M.Sc., Electrical Engineering*2010**Vanderbilt University, Nashville, TN***B.Sc., Engineering Physics***2009**Murray State University, Murray, KY — Summa Cum Laude***PROJECTS**

Codecov — I was involved in a litany of projects at Codecov, many of which are now open source and serve as great examples of how to build large, complex, web software at scale.

Subscriptions — A fan monetization and rewards platform for live-streamers and video content creators. GameWisp's in-house subscription technology was acquired by Lightstream in 2019.

Video Platform — Robust video functionality that allowed content creators to easily upload, distribute, and schedule premium video content.

Singularity APIs — A WebSocket and REST enabled API that allowed third party developers to interact with the GameWisp Subscriptions platform. Actively used by hundreds of developers.